

Vaishnavi

Business channel



UptimeLabs

APP 7:03 AM

joined business-comms-6446. Also, vaishnavi.b and 28 others joined via invite.



Bez

APP 7:09 AM

Customers have gone outrageous. #OBFail and #OBStealsSale are trending with frustrated posts. We're getting hammered online! Where are we @vaishnavi.b?



vaishnavi.b

7:10 AM

Team is looking into the log @Bez. Will keep you posted



vaishnavi.b

APP 7:15 AM

Incident Number INC10007: SEV 1 Resource block at checkout service



Bez

APP 7:15 AM

I'm seeing some posts on social media about issues with our platform, is this a

regional issue or hitting customers globally?

7:17

Got an email claiming responsibility by "BlackCrow Group" and demanding payment of \$5M in crypto. Honestly, I get these hoax emails all the time, so I'm not buying it

7:19

Wait! you're telling me this is an actual ransomware hit?



vaishnavi.b

7:19 AM

@Bez looks like its global issue..Team looking form security perceptive now



Bez

APP 7:19 AM

Alright, tell everyone, no one says a single thing outside online-boutique! I don't care who's asking, not a word until we know exactly what's going on!



vaishnavi.b

7:20 AM

Got it



Bez

APP 7:20 AM

This is nightmare! @vaishnavi.b where are we right now?



vaishnavi.b

7:23 AM

I need suggestion here @Bez @Tinuso. May is asking are we paying the ransom

or moving with response (edited)



Bez

APP 7:23 AM

Not in favor of paying. Ethically, it sets the wrong example and there's no real guarantee we'll get anything back



Tinus

APP 7:23 AM

Agree. Also, just to be clear - we don't need to alert the ICO (Information Commissioner's Office) right this second. We've got up to 72 hours, but that depends on how serious this really is



Bez

APP 7:24 AM

@Tinus do you think this is something we should loop in any cyber security agency for?



Tinus

APP 7:24 AM

If it looks like a complete lock-out, I'd say yes

7:24

We've got Cyvantics Security on retainer - just in case this gets out of hand.
@vaishnavi.b, ask Maya to reach out if needed



Bez

APP 7:25 AM

@vaishnavi.b I need a clear answer from the team. What exactly is affected right now?



Tinus

APP 7:25 AM

You're right. We need clear facts - which systems are locked, which are safe



Bez

APP 7:28 AM

Do we have any backup storage? Maybe we can try restoring from that

7:32

we need an update



vaishnavi.b

7:36 AM

Yes we do have backup till yesterday. Todays data we might lost becuae of Randsome



Bez

APP 7:36 AM

that is to be expected, good work



vaishnavi.b

7:39 AM

We build the new servers and routing the traffic back
now @Bez @Tinus (edited)



Bez

APP 7:39 AM
is this resolved?



vaishnavi.b

7:42 AM

@Bez Users are neither able to see their return requests nor able to place new returns on the site because of data unavailable. Can we proceed with refund for those orders?



Bez

APP 7:42 AM

what loss in sales are we looking at?



vaishnavi.b

7:43 AM

We have data back till yesterday, missing today's checkout data. Anyone who ordered or returned something during that time won't see it - makes sense since we restored from the yesterday's backup



Bez

APP 7:43 AM

Keeping it high-level, just say website restored, but there's an issue with few orders. We'll refund them, and customers will get a \$10 gift voucher as an apology

7:45

Since services are restored, I'm heading to speak with compliance and the regulators. Thankfully, no data was leaked, that helps



Tinus

APP 7:45 AM

I'm on my way to the ICO (Information Commissioner's Office - UK) office now. I'll get the formal report rolling - that's required for the insurance claim. Keep monitoring in the meantime



UptimeLabs

APP 7:48 AM

archived #business-comms-6446. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.



UptimeLabs

APP 7:48 AM

archived #business-comms-6446. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.

Online Boutique



UptimeLabs

APP 7:03 AM

joined online-boutique-6446. Also, vaishnavi.b and 28 others joined via invite.



Bez

APP 7:03 AM

What a day! Our Grand Summer Sale kicked off this morning at 10, and the response has been insane. Can't believe we're already 5 hours in



Bob

APP 7:04 AM

Totally! Just checked the dashboard, we've already crossed \$160k+ in revenue



. The sale energy is next level!



Tinus

APP 7:04 AM

That's fantastic, but hey, this is just the beginning. Three days to go... I'm keeping my fingers crossed



Bez

APP 7:04 AM

Seeing so many people shopping on a holiday, it feels satisfying. Exactly the momentum we were hoping for



UptimeLabs

APP 7:04 AM

Welcome to DEFCON 1, are you prepared for the challenge?.

Use /help at any time for a list of useful links and commands

Use /incident to create an incident record

Once you're ready just click start to begin

7:07



- You have 40 minutes to resolve the outage, good luck! You can type /help if you need any reminders.



Shay

APP 7:07 AM

Not this time!, I just got a few alerts mentioning severe errors popping up in PROD



Bob

APP 7:07 AM

Weird... a few users just complained they are unable to complete their orders. Feels... off..



vaishnavi.b

7:08 AM

Yeah, When I try to place order I could see my cart is empty



Shay

APP 7:09 AM

i see the same issue



vaishnavi.b

7:09 AM

@Shay what error you have observed? please share here



Shay

APP 7:09 AM

Looking into logs now

7:09

Found these below error logs

7:09

```
app[checkout-service] [ERROR] - write() failed, Read-only filesystem
app[checkout-service] Order submission failed for session_id=ae43f9 due to I/
O error
app[checkout-service] [ERROR] - Transaction commit failed, Read-only file
system
[ERROR] nginx[3245] - 502 Bad Gateway while accessing upstream checkout
service
[ERROR] nginx[3245] - 504 Gateway Timeout while accessing upstream
checkout service
```

7:09

The server is too slow and give up while responding back. I'm not sure why read-only errors are there



Daniel

APP 7:10 AM

Looking at the above logs, app looks fine. But system can't write new data. Errors suggests to be an infra component failure

7:10

Also checkout servers show CPU and memory limits exceeded alerts, this definitely looks bigger than just an app issue

7:10

```
app[checkout-service]: systemd[1][WARN] Resource usage threshold
exceeded - CPU: 96%, Memory: 92%
```



Shay

APP 7:10 AM

Could this be due to load or any changes ?



vaishnavi.b

7:11 AM

@Tanya can you take a look on the CPU usage for the checout service?



Tanya

APP 7:11 AM

Checking infra...

7:11

All four checkout servers are maxed out - CPU, memory, and disk I/O all spiking. No changes or deployments were done from platform side

7:11

(92 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/SwdqW9vX/checkout-servers-spike-simultaneous.webp>



vaishnavi.b

7:11 AM

And @Tanya Any recent configuration got modified?



Tanya

APP 7:11 AM

It doesn't looks like a load issue either. CPU and Memory spike is not matching with incoming traffic

7:11

I'm seeing a running process called init_locker.sh eating up most of the CPU on the checkout server. That's not something we usually run. Something's suspicious here

7:11

(12 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/RtWsqrY/process-Running.webp>

7:12

i dont believe any recent configurations were modified



vaishnavi.b

7:12 AM

@Shay @Tanya Any idea in general how much load we will receive?



Tanya

APP 7:13 AM

what customer activity are we at?



Shay

APP 7:13 AM

we shouldnt be at this level of load with the current customer count

7:14

this is really unusual activity



vaishnavi.b

7:14 AM

@Hamed Suggest here do we need to increase of Resources?



Hamed

APP 7:14 AM

let me take a look into this for you now



vaishnavi.b

7:14 AM

/incident SEV 1 Resource block at checkout service (edited)



Hamed

APP 7:15 AM

we seem to be running at max resources right now

7:15

tanya mention the process called in locker, have we looked into this?



UptimeLabs

APP 7:15 AM



Incident record created

7:15



Send first comms in first 5 minutes



Hamed

APP 7:16 AM

and i agree with the team this is highly suspicious activity, we should call in security ops to get thier opinions on this



vaishnavi.b

7:16 AM

@Bob Is it a global issue or any region specific?



Bob

APP 7:16 AM

Sure, let me look at my reports

7:16

Here are some of the complaints we've received in the last few minutes. It's coming all across the globe

7:16

Germany - "I added items to my cart, clicked checkout, and it just kept spinning. Then it dumped me back to an empty cart"

7:16

USA - "Order failed twice, and now the cart is empty. I refreshed, but now the site is laggy"

7:16

Japan - "Got to checkout, then error 502. Tried again - cart gone"

7:16

To sum it all, we have got 240+ reports globally

7:16

(12 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/7csQGjg/Lvl-26-reports-2.webp>



vaishnavi.b

7:17 AM

@Maya please check we seeing more anonymous calls.....



Maya

APP 7:17 AM

Let me check if there's anything suspicious

7:17

Weird!! Security agent known as EDR(Endpoint Detection and Response) is missing from all 4 checkout servers. That's? concerning

7:17

EDR is basically our endpoint defense tool, it tracks unusual activity at the servers

7:17

Also, I found an init_locker.sh script encrypting DB, app, and log files which is renaming the filename like below

7:18

order_log_2025-06-01.locked
session_state.tmp.locked



Daniel

APP 7:18 AM

this explains why there were errors in checkout logs saying write failed , read-only filesystem



Tanya

APP 7:18 AM

Wait... there's a file here named HELP_ME_DECRYPT.txt. I opened it, appears a ransom note. This doesn't look good

7:18

(27 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/HDcr1Rzb/ransomnote.webp>



vaishnavi.b

7:18 AM

@Bob looks like its not region specific



Maya

APP 7:18 AM

Confirmed. This is a ransomware breach. @vaishnavi.b inform business about this



Tanya

APP 7:18 AM

Shall i try killing this script ?



Bob

APP 7:18 AM

Guys!!! User complaints are sky rocketing, its turning catastrophic!



vaishnavi.b

7:19 AM

@Hamed Killing the scripting will help?



Hamed

APP 7:20 AM

im not sure, we shouldn't panic on this, @maya you know best what do do, can you answer this?



Maya

APP 7:20 AM

Killing the script could make things worse, higher ransom or losing data forever

7:20

@vaishnavi.b before we do anything, I'd request everyone to please change

their passwords

7:20

Also I'm removing everyone's access to servers - only I'll have control for now.
Later we will reassess to do any activity further



Daniel

APP 7:20 AM

Done on my end



Hamed

APP 7:20 AM

Updated. @Maya smart move by limiting server's access



Shay

APP 7:20 AM

Password updated



Bob

APP 7:20 AM

Changed mine too. Better safe than sorry



Tanya

APP 7:21 AM

All set

7:21

It's much worse now. Every file I check is encrypted, nothing can be opened or recovered.



Shay

APP 7:21 AM

I'm seeing new errors on frontend now. How's it for you @vaishnavi.b ?



Maya

APP 7:21 AM

Attention! when it comes to potential security breaches, it's important we don't discuss sensitive details here

7:21

I'm setting up private channel...

7:21

@vaishnavi.b before we move to private channel, can you check with business what's the plan - are we paying the ransom or moving with response?



vaishnavi.b

7:21 AM

503 on checkout page now



Maya

APP 7:22 AM

this is due to the ransomware

7:22

they are restricting all access to them files



vaishnavi.b

7:22 AM

Checking Maya



Bob

APP 7:27 AM

@vaishnavi.b user complaints are spiking. They're reporting the site is down,

earlier it wasn't the case. What should I tell them now?



vaishnavi.b

7:35 AM

Backup is restoring now Bob. We will be back in sometime



UptimeLabs

APP 7:42 AM



- You have less than 5 minutes. You can type /help if you need any reminders.



Maya

APP 7:44 AM

Do we go ahead and mark this incident as closed?



vaishnavi.b

7:45 AM

Yes I could place order now



Tanya

APP 7:45 AM

That was intense. We've never been this close to total loss before. We got lucky



Daniel

APP 7:45 AM

Systems are calm now, but that feeling earlier... not something I want to go through again



Bob

APP 7:45 AM

One small slip caused a major breach. We need better awareness to prevent this in future



vaishnavi.b

7:45 AM

Thanks all



Tinus

APP 7:45 AM

This could've gone way worse. Appreciate how quickly and cleanly you handled it



Bez

APP 7:46 AM

Not every day we survive an attack like this. You made the right calls, fast. Great job, @vaishnavi.b - that's how we bounce back



1

Private Channel



UptimeLabs

APP 7:03 AM

joined private-comms-6446. Also,
Hamed S
and 20 others joined via invite.



Maya

APP 7:24 AM

@vaishnavi.b let's build the core response team here. I've already added myself. Who else should we pull in to keep it tight and efficient?

7:24

I'd say one senior person each from security, platform, and engineering. Also add Tanya, tasks could be platform intensive



vaishnavi.b

7:25 AM

@Maya Please reach out Cyvantics Security on retainer



Maya

APP 7:25 AM

Yes, we've got an IR(incident response) retainer with Cyvantics Security

7:25

Looped in Cyvantics Security - they're on their way now to take snapshots of the infected server and storage, followed by forensics on it

7:26

Meanwhile, I've got this from Cyvantics. @vaishnavi.b, can you help track the steps and coordinate?

7:26

<https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/external/MThjMTk4ZDU5ODU0NGZmMWE1NzhmNGY0MDQwNWl1NTA>

7:26

We've got isolation steps in the playbook, but before we dive in, can you paste that list here? I'll help team run through it



vaishnavi.b

7:27 AM

Steps to be done, mentioned along with the **owning** team

1. Disconnect the infected server -> Platforms
2. Cut off infrastructure traffic -> Platforms
3. Disconnect DB & freeze backup -> Application
4. Detach from Shared Resource -> Platforms
5. Take snapshots (Disk & Memory) -> Ask team
6. Kill suspicious process or activity -> Platforms



Maya

APP 7:27 AM

I've given write access to Tanya, Hamed, Daniel, and myself



Tanya

APP 7:27 AM

Disconnecting the checkout servers from the infra now



Daniel

APP 7:27 AM

I'm on it. Disconnecting DB access for checkout and checking if scheduled backups exist



Hamed

APP 7:27 AM

I'll verify if any shared storage is still attached to the checkout DB



Daniel

APP 7:28 AM

Step 3 done, DB connection to checkout is now cut



Tanya

APP 7:28 AM

Step 1 done, Checkout servers are now fully disconnected. Moving to isolate the infra from all external traffic



Hamed

APP 7:28 AM

Step 4 confirmed, No shared storage attached to checkout, which makes sense since checkout has its standalone storage



Tanya

APP 7:28 AM

Step 2 completed, Infra is now fully cut off from the outside world. That means the website will remain completely down until we recover



Maya

APP 7:28 AM

Step 5 done, Cyvantics has completed taking snapshots of the checkout servers and database. They've now moved on to forensics. @Hamed, we're good to kill the script now



Hamed

APP 7:28 AM

Step 6 done, The Script has been killed. @vaishnavi.b let us know and double-

check if anything else is pending on our side



vaishnavi.b

7:29 AM

We are good with the isolations steps



Maya

APP 7:30 AM

yes all looks good there i agree



vaishnavi.b

7:30 AM

Can we proceed with Restoration?



Maya

APP 7:30 AM

Yes, we must have a backup. Platform team can confirm us



Hamed

APP 7:30 AM

Correct, we do have backup which only runs at 2AM. Latest is yesterday's.
We'll lose today's orders



Maya

APP 7:30 AM

Isolation is complete. We're good to move toward restoration using the backup

storage now

7:30

@vaishnavi.b could you please confirm with business before moving forward on this

7:30

I've called in @Bob to the channel



Bob

APP 7:31 AM

@vaishnavi.b, I hear you need my help, what exactly should I look into?

7:31

With the sale starting today, the potential loss is significant - around \$180k



vaishnavi.b

7:31 AM

@Hamed S Is there a way we can retain today's data?



Hamed

APP 7:32 AM

No all of the sales are lost with the ransomware

7:32

if we restore we lose all their sales



Maya

APP 7:32 AM

unfortunately yes



vaishnavi.b

7:33 AM

Looks like we need to proceed with our restoration process with current back what we have



Maya

APP 7:33 AM

is that the decision? just want to make it clear what the next actions are



vaishnavi.b

7:33 AM

Steps for Restoration:

Steps to be done, mentioned along with the **owning** team

1. Validate backups → Security
2. Wipe infected systems → Platforms
3. Rebuild from clean backup → Platforms
4. Re-enable security agent on the servers → Security
5. Reconnect traffic to services and monitor → Platforms



Maya

APP 7:34 AM

Thanks for the go-ahead. @vaishnavi.b, please track all restoration steps



1

7:34

I'm now validating the backup storage to ensure it's safe



Hamed

APP 7:34 AM

I'm provisioning new checkout servers, will update once ready



Maya

APP 7:34 AM

Backup is clean and safe. @Hamed, you can start rebuilding checkout from backup storage



Hamed

APP 7:34 AM

Thanks, Maya. New servers are ready. I'll start rebuilding now using backup storage

7:34

Rebuild completed



Maya

APP 7:34 AM

I've enabled the security agents (EDR) on checkout servers



Daniel

APP 7:34 AM

I'll monitor application health once services are restored



Maya

APP 7:34 AM

@vaishnavi.b , can you confirm all tasks are wrapped up and we are good to bring the traffic back? Just want to be sure, as this is the final restoration step before we move



Tanya

APP 7:36 AM

im ready on the last step



vaishnavi.b

7:37 AM

@Tanya are we wiped the infected server?



Maya

APP 7:37 AM

i will check this

7:37

no we missed that, good catch, let me carry that out now



1

7:38

Complete, we are good to go now



vaishnavi.b

7:38 AM

@Tanya go head with last step



Tanya

APP 7:38 AM

Thanks for the go ahead. Bringing up network traffic in progress...



1

7:39

Restoration completed



Bob

APP 7:39 AM

Wait!! getting a bunch of new complaints now. Users are neither able to see their return requests nor able to place new returns on the site



Maya

APP 7:39 AM

Yeah, that's probably the missing today's checkout data. Anyone who ordered or returned something during that time won't see it - makes sense since we restored from the yesterday's backup



Tanya

APP 7:39 AM

Tough, but expected :)



Bob

APP 7:39 AM

What should I tell them? They are asking for refunds



Maya

APP 7:43 AM

@vaishnavi.b I've received the forensics report from Cyvantics Security

7:43

(85 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/q3Jp58dv/CONFIDENTIAL-6-page-0001.webp>



vaishnavi.b

7:44 AM

Update from Business,

@Bob We'll refund them, and customers will get a \$10 gift voucher as an apology (edited)



Maya

APP 7:44 AM

Also, I just finished combing through Shay's mailbox. There's something important here, I found two emails from what looks like our monitoring vendor - ClearTech

7:44

(103 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/VpLJHh7y/CT-20250829-055655-0000.webp>

7:44

We will take this forward in PIR , for now website is restored

7:44

Alright, since everything's back up and stable, we can now move back to the main #online-boutique channel. No further actions left here



vaishnavi.b

7:45 AM

Thanks @Maya



UptimeLabs

APP 7:48 AM

archived #private-comms-6446. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.



UptimeLabs

APP 7:48 AM

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